9815

Rotary District 9815 · Pre-PELDS 2026
Session summary for Presidents-Elect and Membership Chairs

From *Why me?* to *Why not me?*

Your year as President, and the leader it will make you. Here's what we covered, and where to go next.

Let's name it

Clubs are finding it hard to find Presidents, and many of you don't have a mentor at your club. That's why the District, the PE Toolkit and the people around you will walk beside you this year. **You won't be doing it alone.**

> *"You don't have to be the best Rotarian in the room. You just have to care, ask good questions, and let other people shine."*

This isn't a job. It's a leadership course, with a team to practise on.

Chairing meetings
Run a room, keep it on track, make decisions stick.

Influence
Lead volunteers, where nobody has to do what you say.

Delegation
Grow other people instead of doing it all yourself.

Strategy
Pick two or three things that matter and see them through.

Speaking
Find your voice with members, partners and media.

Culture
Shape how your club feels on a meeting night.

Three jobs. Not thirty.

1 Set direction
Agree the club's two or three priorities and keep everyone pointed at them.

2 Build the team
A capable Board with clear roles, and chairs you support and recognise.

3 Look after the people
Members feel welcome, useful and noticed. Grow your successor.

BUILDING BLOCK ONE

Your *one-page* club plan

Where are we now?
Members, trends, projects, money and mood. Be honest.

Where do we want to be on 30 June?
Picture your changeover night.

What will we do to get there?
Two or three goals, each with a number and an owner.

Your **My Presidential Plan** workbook walks you through these questions. On the District website, the **Leadership Hub** (Your Role → Leadership Hub → Start Guided Flow) covers running your club, great Board meetings, a quarter-by-quarter Year Planner and succession.

One habit that changes Board meetings: open every meeting with *"What is the most important thing we could decide today?"*

BUILDING BLOCK TWO

Membership *starts with you*

Membership growth is the outcome. The club experience is the driver. The District 9815 Membership Growth Strategy 2026–2029 aims to grow membership by **15% over three years**, while improving engagement, diversity, retention and club vitality. Every Rotarian champions membership, not just the Membership Chair.

Four things only the President can do

- Personally invite at least two people this year
- Welcome every new member, and give them a real job within weeks
- Make membership a standing Board item: members, joins, departures, net growth, at risk
- Notice who's drifting, and pick up the phone

A new member's first year

- A support contact or mentor from day one
- A structured induction within 90 days
- A real role early, matched to why they joined
- Check-ins at 3, 6 and 12 months

Help: the District **Membership Hub** (Your Role → Membership Hub), and **Club Assist** on the Rotary South Pacific site (choose Victoria, then "Retention & engagement" or "Attraction").

MAKE IT REAL

Put your goals in *My Rotary*

1. Go to **my.rotary.org** and **Sign in** (or **Register** with the email your club has for you).
2. Open **Rotary Club Central** and choose the **right Rotary year** at the top.
3. Look at your club's **history and trends** first, then set a realistic membership goal, ideally together with your Membership Chair.
4. Add your **Foundation** giving goals, and **Save** each one before moving on.

Your first three moves

This week
Open the PE Toolkit and answer "Why did you say yes?"

This month
Ask someone to be your mentor: a past President from any club.

Before 1 July
Your one-page plan, your membership pledge, and your goals in Club Central.

Where to find help

Scan with your phone camera, or type the address. **Your Assistant Governor is always your first call.**

Your take-home pack
david-rotary.github.io/PELDS2026/take-home.html

Leadership Hub
rotary9815.org.au/page/leadership-flow

Membership Hub
rotary9815.org.au/page/membership-flow

Club Assist
rotarysouthpacific.org · Victoria + "Club President"

My Rotary + Club Central
my.rotary.org

Rotary Learning Center
Club President Essentials 1 and 2

You said yes. That's the hardest part done.
Let's build the leader it makes you.